



Xbox Smartglass launch

Microsoft launched the free Smartglass app for the Xbox 360, letting tablets and smartphones turn into content controllers for the console

HTC Release Dates confirmed

HTC's One X+, 8X and 8S have finally had their launch dates confirmed, and are expected by November 2nd

iBall Andi 5c

A budget 5-inch Android ICS phone

This 5-inch phone is powered by a 1 GHz Cortex A9 single-core processor and has an IPS panel with a highly reflective screen. It can take in two SIM cards (2 x GSM or 1 GSM + 1 WCDMA). The textured finish on the rear side gives it a very good grip but it is quite heavier than the Samsung Galaxy Note.

You will get a stock Android ICS with no customisations, which is a big plus. The onboard keypad wasn't that great. One hand typing is slow and will lead to thumb-ache. Typing in the landscape mode is quick. Call quality was quite good except in Zone 3 where you have just one bar on the signal. It beat Karbonn A18 and Spice Stellar MI 425 in most of the benchmarks. The IPS panel's backlight



Price: ₹12,999

bleeding is very prominent along the edges if you view the screen at eye-level. Visibility in sunlight is horrible. It sports a 5 MP rear-camera and a VGA front-camera. The camera tends to take quite a while to focus and it gets worse in low lit conditions. The images taken outdoors were actually pretty decent for this category of phone. Yes, the dynamic range isn't great and you will see pixellation when you transfer images to your PC. The outdoor images look great on the phone screen and you shouldn't expect anything more from this phone. Video quality is not at all good.

The 2300mAh battery lasts for a decent 8 hours on regular usage which includes calling, messaging, a bit of gaming, watching movies and surfing the web.

At a maximum retail price of ₹12,999 but an MOP of ₹11,000, the Andi 5c is still expensive. But under ₹10,000 this can make for a great buy for someone looking at a budget large-screen phone. Prospective buyers, wait for more budget 5-inch smartphones to launch.

Nimish Sawant

Creative Inspire S2 Wireless 2.1

Decent but expensive



Price: ₹4,990

The S2 can wirelessly play music by pairing with any A2DP compatible device. Performance wise the S2 is no big deal. You'll get the same signature bass heavy sound that Creative is known for in their lower end Inspire series. However, bluetooth pairing was a breeze with the controls within reach. The bundled D1 transmitter with its Apt-X codec support ensures higher fidelity over the air. The speaker set is certainly expensive. Go for it if pairing wirelessly is a must and space is a concern. The compact footprint makes this set an ideal companion for a laptop.



Features70
Performance.....60
Build Quality60
Value for money.....50

Specifications

Frequency response: 40Hz - 20 KHz; S/N Ratio: >= 75dB; Output power: 26 W

Contact

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Amkette Smart Bluetooth keyboard

A handy dedicated keyboard for your tablet



Price: ₹2,795

Setting it up on an iPad and an Android tablet is simple. Once paired, you get this additional on-screen keyboard, which also remains active. There are dedicated keys for the Android and iOS ecosystem, like Search and Home. There is literally no spacing between the keys, which takes time getting used to. However, its typing experience is good, and build quality is great. Keys have a chunky feel, travel is adequate and the key-size is perfect. Lack of palmrest means you can't type for long without feeling stressed. It's priced very well.



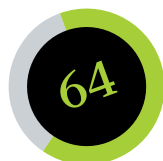
Features60
Ergonomics65
Build Quality80
Value for money.....75

Specifications

Connectivity type: Bluetooth 2.0; Compatibility: iOS 4 and above, Android 3.0 and above, Windows XP/Vista/7, Mac OS Snow Leopard and above; Battery: 2 AAA alkaline

Contact

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Features70
Performance.....60
Build Quality60
Value for money.....65

Specifications

Operating System: Android 4.0.3; Screen size: 5-inch WVGA at 480x800 pixel; Internal Storage: 4 GB (2 GB for data); RAM: 512 MB; Camera (rear / front) in MP: 5 / 0.3; Connectivity: 3G, EDGE, GPRS, Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n, Bluetooth with A2DP; Dual-SIM: Yes; Battery: 2300mAh

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